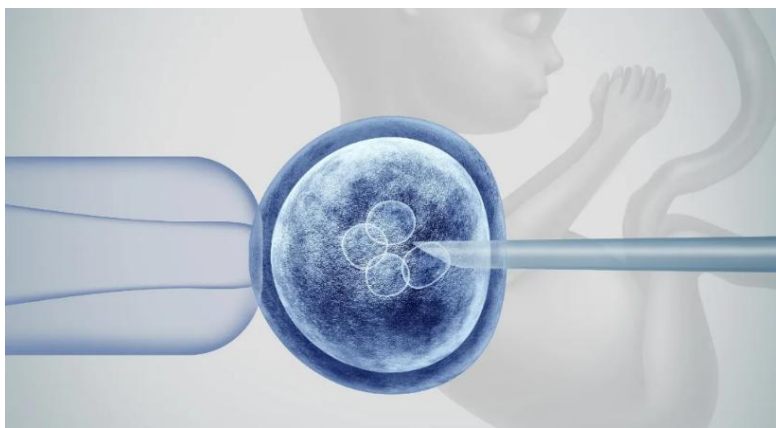




Screening for success

筛选出成功者

难度评级：★★★★☆

In praise of designer-ish babies

为“定制婴儿”正名

【 Para.1 】

Having transformed human life, Silicon Valley is now coming for birth. A **spate** of startups offer screening services that allow **couples** having children via **in-vitro fertilisation (IVF)** to assess **embryos** based on their **genetic** risk of diseases such as breast cancer and **diabetes**. Some **venture** further **into** science-fiction territory, providing scores for IQ and height, or even eye and hair colour.

硅谷已经改变了人类的生活，如今又把目光投向生育领域。一批初创公司纷纷推出胚胎筛查服务，让通过体外受精（IVF）生育的夫妇，可以根据胚胎罹患乳腺癌、糖尿病等疾病的遗传风险对其进行评估。有些公司更进一步，涉足科幻般的领域，为胚胎的智商、身高，甚至瞳色和头色进行评分。

文章导读：

硅谷进军生育领域，初创公司通过胚胎筛查预测疾病风险及个人特征。评者担忧胚胎筛查的技术与伦理风险，但反对全面禁止。胚胎筛查尚属小众，但成本下降和竞争压力可能推动其普及。医学界质疑多基因预测的成熟度，英国则对胚胎筛选实行更严格监管。多基因评分存在局限：只能估算患病风险，且对欧洲祖源人群的预测更准确。风险降低有限且父母的选择受胚胎条件限制。应加强信息披露和独立审查，技术进步将提升多基因评分的准确。生育技术进步引发伦理争议，焦点包括自然生育、公平性及“新优生主义”。反对理由站不住脚，胚胎筛查与历史优生学有本质区别。渴望聪明孩子的夫妇应重视后天培养，政府不应阻碍父母获取胚胎信息。

spate n. /spet/ A large number or amount of something that happens or appears within a short period. 大量；一连串；突然增加【考研大纲词汇】

A **spate** of new studies has examined the effects of artificial intelligence. 大量新的研究考察了人工智能的影响。

couple n. /'kʌpl/ Two people or things considered together; a small number of people or things. 两个；一对；几个【考研大纲词汇】

in-vitro fertilisation (IVF) n. /'m vi:trəʊ 'fɜ:təlaɪ' zeɪʃn/ A medical process in which an egg is fertilised by sperm outside the body and the resulting embryo is placed in the uterus. 体外受精

embryo n. /'embriəʊ/ A very young organism developing in the womb or, in the early stages, outside the body during assisted reproduction. 胚胎【考研大纲词汇】

The **embryo** was carefully examined before being implanted. 胚胎在移植前接受了仔细检查。

genetic a. /dʒə'netɪk/ Relating to genes or the characteristics passed from parents to their children. 基因的；遗传的【考研大纲词汇】

Scientists are studying the **genetic** causes of the disease. 科学家正在研究这种疾病的遗传原因。

diabetes n. /daɪə'bi:tɪz/ A serious medical condition in which the body cannot properly control the level of sugar in the blood. 糖尿病【考研大纲词汇】

A healthy diet can reduce the risk of developing **diabetes**. 健康的饮食可以降低患糖尿病的风险。

【 Para.2 】

Critics are **dismayed**. Some worry firms are pushing **immature** technology onto **vulnerable** couples. Others say that even if the tech works, its use is **immoral**. Both arguments contain **kernels** of truth; neither is ultimately **convincing**. Banning or heavily restricting embryo screening would be a mistake.

批评者对此深感不安。有人担心，这些公司正在把尚不成熟的技术推向易受影响的夫妇。另一些人则认为，即便这项技术确实有效，使用它也是不道德的。这两种观点都有一定道理，但归根结底，都缺乏足够的说服力。禁止胚胎筛查，或对其施加过于严苛的限制，都是错误的。

【 Para.3 】

For now, the debate is a **niche** concern. The **startups** mostly **cater to** the rich, famous and odd. Yet that will change. A wave of investment means that the cost of IVF is likely to fall. If offered embryo screening at the same time, many couples will take it. One survey suggests that three-quarters of Americans support screening embryos for diseases; about a third say the same for non-disease traits. And that is before competitive pressure kicks in. Who wants to see their child **bested** by genetically selected classmates?

目前，这场争论还只是一个小众议题。这些初创公司主要服务于富人、名人以及一些特立独行的人。但这种情况将会改变。一波投资热潮意味着，体外受精（IVF）的成本很可能会下降。如果同时提供胚胎筛查，许多夫妇都会接受。一项调查显示，四分之三的

venture into phrase To go into a place, activity, or subject that is new, unfamiliar, or potentially risky. 涉足；进入；冒险涉足【考研英语词汇】

The company is **venturing into** a new area of medical research. 这家公司正在涉足一个新的医学研究领域。

fiction n. /'fɪkʃn/ Stories, books, or films that describe imaginary events and people rather than real ones. 小说；虚构作品；虚构的事物【考研英语词汇】

Genetic engineering was once considered the stuff of science **fiction**.

基因工程曾一度被认为只是科幻作品中的东西。

territory n. /'terətri/ An area of land controlled by a particular country or group; an area of knowledge or activity. 领土；领域；范围【考研英语词汇】

The researchers are venturing into largely unexplored **territory**.

研究人员正在涉足一个基本未被探索的领域。

dismayed a. /dɪ'smeɪd/ Feeling very worried, disappointed, or upset by something unexpected or unpleasant. 感到惊愕的；沮丧的；失望的【考研英语词汇】

She was **dismayed** by the lack of progress in the project. 她对项目进展缓慢感到失望。

immature a. /,ɪmə'tʃʊə(r)/ Not fully developed physically, mentally, or emotionally; not sufficiently developed or experienced. 不成熟的；未发育完全的；不完善的【考研英语词汇】

vulnerable a. /'vʌlnərəbl/ Easily harmed, influenced, or attacked because of being weak or lacking protection. 脆弱的；易受伤害的；易受影响的【考研英语词汇】

Young children are particularly **vulnerable** to infectious diseases. 儿童尤其容易受到传染病的侵害。

Immoral a. /ɪ'mɒrəl/ Not morally acceptable; contrary to accepted standards of right and wrong. 不道德的；违背道德规范的【考研英语词汇】

Some people believe that using genetic technology in this way is **immoral**.

有些人认为以这种方式使用基因技术是不道德的。

kernel n. /'kɜːnl/ The inner part of a seed, nut, or grain; the central or most important part of something. 果仁；籽粒；核心；最重要的部分【考研英语词汇】

At the **kernel** of the debate is a question about human rights. 这场争论的核心是一个关于人权的问题

convincing a. /kən'vɪnsɪŋ/ Making someone believe that something is true or correct because it is based on good evidence or reasoning. 令人信服的；有说服力的【考研英语词汇】

The researchers provided **convincing** evidence to support their argument. 研究人员提供了有力的证据来支持他们的论点。

niche n. /niːʃ/ A specialized position or area of activity that suits a particular group or type of product. 细分市场；利基市场；合适的位置【考研英语词汇】

The company has found a profitable **niche** in the growing technology market. 这家公司在不断增长的科技市场中找到了一个有利可图的细分市场。

美国人支持通过胚胎疾病筛选；约三分之一的人也支持非疾病类性状筛查。而这还没有考虑到竞争压力的影响。谁愿意看到自己的孩子被那些经过基因筛选的同学比下去呢？

【 Para.4 】

Many medics—including nearly every genetics and **reproductive**-medicine group in the rich world—question whether such “**polygenic**” prediction is ready for consumers. In Britain, where **fertility** is more regulated than in America, selecting an embryo on the basis of non-approved factors is unlawful.

许多医学界人士——包括发达国家几乎所有的遗传学和生殖医学机构——都对这种“多基因预测”技术是否已经成熟到可以面向消费者表示质疑。在英国，生育医疗的监管比美国更为严格，根据未经批准的因素来选择胚胎是违法行为。

【 Para.5 】

There are indeed reasons for **caution**. Polygenic scores are **tricky**. For many diseases caused by a single gene, testing offers near-certainty: if an embryo has the material, it will develop the condition. Yet an assessment of multiple genes leads to risk estimates, rather than a **binary** answer—and such estimates are more accurate for people with European **ancestry**, because they are better represented in genetic databases.

的确有理由保持谨慎。多基因评分并不简单，存在诸多棘手之处。对于许多由单基因引起的疾病，基因检测几乎可以给出确定结果：如果一个胚胎携带致病基

startup n. /'sta:tʌp/ A new business, especially one that is based on innovative ideas or technology and aims to grow quickly. 初创公司；创业企业

cater to phrase To provide what a particular person or group wants or needs. 满足……的需求；迎合……【考研大纲词汇】

best v. /best/ To defeat someone or do better than someone, especially in a competition or challenge. 击败；胜过；战胜【熟词偏义】

The young athlete **bested** several experienced competitors in the final.

这名年轻运动员在决赛中击败了几位经验丰富的竞争者。

reproductive a. /ri:prə'dʌktɪv/ Relating to the process of producing offspring or having children. 生殖的；繁殖的

polygenic a. /ˌpɒli'dʒenɪk/ Caused or influenced by several different genes rather than by a single gene. 多基因的；由多个基因共同决定的【非考研大纲词汇】

Height is a **polygenic** trait influenced by many different genes.

身高是一种由许多不同基因共同影响的多基因性状。

fertility n. /fə'tɪləti/ The ability to produce children or offspring. 生育能力；生殖能力【考研大纲词汇】

The treatment can improve **fertility** in some patients.

这种治疗可以改善一些患者的生育能力。

caution n. /'kɔ:ʃn/ Care taken to avoid danger, mistakes, or problems. 谨慎；小心；警告【考研大纲词汇】

Scientists have urged **caution** when interpreting the results of the study.

科学家敦促人们在解读这项研究结果时保持谨慎。

tricky a. /'tri:ki/ Difficult to deal with or understand, especially because it involves complicated or unexpected problems. 棘手的；难处理的；复杂的

binary a. /'baɪnəri/ Involving or consisting of two parts, groups, or choices. 二元的；由两部分组成的

ancestry n. /'ænsɛstri/ The people in your family who lived before you, especially your ancestors and their origins. 祖先；家世；血统；祖源【非考研大纲词汇】

Genetic tests can reveal information about a person's **ancestry**.

基因检测可以揭示一个人的祖源信息。

caveat n. /'kæviæt/ A caveat is a warning of a specific limitation of something such as information or an agreement. 警告；提醒

reduction n. /rɪ'dʌkʃn/ The act of making something smaller in size, amount, price, or degree. 减少；降低；缩减【考研大纲词汇】

The policy has led to a significant **reduction** in carbon emissions.

这项政策使碳排放量大幅减少。

因，那么就会发病。然而，多基因评估只能给出患病
的风险评估，无法得出是或否的结论；而且，对于具
有欧洲祖源的人群，这类风险估计更为准确，因为基
因数据库中该种群的样本更加充分。

【 Para.6 】

Further **caveats** are in order. Risk **reductions** can look large
in **relative** terms but be small in absolute ones, particularly
for rare diseases. Selecting for some traits may raise the risk
of other less **desirable** ones. Even for highly genetically
determined traits like height, parents remain limited by the
range found in their own embryos.

有必要再给出几点警示。风险降从相对值来看可能很
大，但从绝对值来看却很小，尤其是对于罕见疾病而
言。针对某些特征进行筛选，可能会增加其他不良特
征出现的风险。即使是像身高这样受遗传因素影响很
大的特征，父母的选择也受限于自身胚胎已有的基因
限制范围。

【 Para.7 】

These facts are an argument for **disclosure**, however, rather
than legal **restrictions** or **outright** bans. If companies want
to offer polygenic scoring, they must adequately
communicate the technology's limits and risks. They
should also let their tests undergo independent scrutiny.
This will not **scupper** a **nascent** business, since the startups
are not, as some critics allege, selling snake oil. A study in
2019 found that parents choosing from among ten embryos
may be able to boost their child's height by 1-6cm and IQ
by between one and seven points—with tech that is now

relative n. /'relatɪv/ A person who is related to you by
blood or marriage. 亲属；亲戚【考研大纲词汇】

desirable a. /dɪ'zʌərəbl/ Wanted or considered to be
good, useful, or attractive. 理想的；值得拥有的；令人向往的
【考研大纲词汇】

Genetic screening may help parents select the most
desirable traits. 基因筛查可能帮助父母选择最理想的特征。

disclosure n. /dɪ'sklʊʒə(r)/ The act of making
information known, especially information that was
previously secret or private. 公开；披露；揭露【考研大纲词
汇】

restriction n. /rɪ'strɪkʃn/ An official rule or limit that
controls what people can do or what is allowed. 限制；约
束；限制规定【考研大纲词汇】

outright a. /'aʊtraɪt/ Completely and directly, without
any attempt to hide or limit something. 完全的；彻底的；
【考研大纲词汇】

scupper n. /'skʌpər/to cause sb/sth to fail使泡汤；使成泡影

nascent a. /'neɪs(ə)nt/beginning to exist; not yet fully
developed新生的；萌芽的；未成熟的

database n. /'deɪtəbeɪs/ An organized collection of
information that can be stored, searched, and used by a
computer. 数据库【考研大纲词汇】

Researchers used a large **database** to study genetic
differences among populations.

研究人员利用一个大型数据库研究不同人群之间的基因差异。

fertility n. /fə'tɪləti/ The ability to produce children or
offspring. 生育能力；生殖能力【考研大纲词汇】

Advances in medicine have helped many couples overcome
fertility problems.

医学进步帮助许多夫妇克服了生育方面的问题。

offspring n. /'ɒfsprɪŋ/ A person's or animal's child or
children; the young produced by a person, animal, or plant.
后代；子女；幼崽【考研大纲词汇】

Parents naturally want to protect their **offspring** from harm.
父母自然希望保护自己的子女免受伤害。

entrepreneur n. /'ɒntrəprə'naɪz(r)/ A person who starts
and manages a business, especially one who takes financial
risks in order to make a profit. 企业家；创业者【考研大纲词
汇】

eugenicist n. /'juːdʒɪnɪst/ people in support of growing
excellent people优生学家；主张改良人种者

zealot n. /'zelət/ A person who is extremely enthusiastic
about a particular belief or cause and is unwilling to accept
different opinions. 狂热分子；狂热者

desperate a. /'despəreɪt/ Feeling or showing that you have
a strong need or desire for something and are willing to try
anything to get it. 极度渴望的；不顾一切的；绝望的【考研大
纲词汇】

Desperate to have a child, the couple decided to try in-vitro
fertilisation.

这对夫妇非常渴望拥有孩子，于是决定尝试体外受精。

nearly a decade old. As genetic **databases** get better and cover broader populations, and AI draws out the relationship between genes and traits, scores will improve.

这些事实恰恰说明，真正需要的是信息披露，而不是通过法律实施限制，更不是一刀切地禁止。如果公司想提供多基因评分服务，就必须充分向消费者说明这项技术的局限性和风险。他们还应当接受独立机构的审查。这样做并不会扼杀这个新兴行业，因为正如一些批评者所指责的那样，这些初创公司并不是在兜售骗人的东西。2019年的一项研究发现，如果父母从10个胚胎中进行筛选，或许能够使孩子的身高增加1—6厘米，智商提高1—7分——而当时使用的技术距今已有近十年的历史。随着基因数据库不断完善、覆盖的人群更加广泛，以及人工智能进一步揭示基因与各类性状之间的关系，多基因评分的准确性也将不断提高。

【 Para.8 】

Such progress will raise difficult ethical questions. Some, including the “Make America Healthy Again” movement, argue that **fertility** tech corrupts what should be a natural process. Others worry that if polygenic screening is limited to the rich, their **offspring** will have another unfair advantage. The scariest critique is that fertility **entrepreneurs** are this century’s **eugenicists**.

这种进步将引发一些棘手的伦理问题。一些人——包括“让美国再次健康”（Make America Healthy Again）运动的支持者——认为，生育技术正在扭曲本应遵循自然规律的生育过程。另一些人则担心，如果多基因

➤ 今日句子分析

For many diseases **caused by a single gene**, **testing** **offers**

介词状语 名词 修饰 disease 的后置定语 主语 谓语

near-certainty: **if an embryo has the material**, **it will**

宾语 条件从句 主语 谓语

develop **the condition**.

宾语

1. 整体结构

For many diseases caused by a single gene: 介词短语作状语，说明适用范围

testing offers near-certainty: 主句

→ if条件句冒号后进一步解释为什么说 testing offers near-certainty。“if an embryo has the material, it will develop the condition.”

2. For many diseases caused by a single gene这里容易看错结构。

For many diseases: 对于许多疾病，caused by a single gene过去分词短语，修饰 diseases

完整结构: many diseases [caused by a single gene]

其中: cause = 导致

caused by a single gene = 由单个基因导致的。所以: many diseases caused by a single gene = 许多由单个基因引起的疾病

这里的 caused 是被动含义，相当于: many diseases which are caused by a single gene

3. testing offers near-certainty

这是整个句子的核心主干:

testing + offers + near-certainty

testing: 检测，检测手段

offer: 提供; 带来

near-certainty: 近乎确定的结果

所以: testing offers near-certainty: 检测几乎可以给出确定的结果。

这里的 testing 是动名词作主语，不是现在进行时。

类似: Testing can identify the problem.检测可以发现问题。

5. if an embryo has the material, it will develop the condition

这是标准的第一类条件句:

If + 一般现在时, 主语 + will + 动词原形

结构:

if an embryo has the material

如果一个胚胎具有这种遗传物质

it will develop the condition

它就会患上这种疾病

筛查仅限于富人使用，那么他们的后代将拥有另一项不公平的优势。最令人担忧的一种批评是：生育技术领域的企业家就是这个世纪的优生论者。

【 Para.9 】

But none of these arguments stands up to scrutiny. “Unnatural” technology is already used in many modern births: this argument against embryo selection just as easily applies to IVF, for instance, which only **zealots** want banned. Costs should come down, making screening more widely available. And there is a big difference between the murderous coercion of early-20th-century eugenics programmes and parents seeking as much knowledge as possible when picking an embryo.

但这些说法经不起推敲。“非自然”的技术早已广泛用于现代分娩：例如，反对胚胎筛选的论点同样适用于体外受精（IVF），而真正主张禁止IVF的也只有少数狂热分子。随着成本下降，胚胎筛查也会变得更加普及。更重要的是，20世纪初优生学计划中那种带有杀戮性质的强制手段，与父母在选择胚胎时尽可能获取更多信息，两者之间存在着天壤之别。

【 Para.10 】

Couples **desperate** for a clever child might be better advised to focus on what happens after birth. Yet so long as parents understand there is no such thing as the perfect baby, the state should not stand in the way of a bit more information.

那些渴望生出聪明孩子的夫妇，或许更应该把精力放在孩子出生后如何培养上。不过，只要父母明白，世

写作积累

(Para.1) Some venture further into science-fiction territory, providing scores for IQ and height, or even eye and hair colour.

venture into是一个非常实用的短语，核心意思是：冒险进入；涉足；开始从事某个自己不熟悉或相对新颖的领域。这里的venture本身有“冒险、冒险尝试”的意思，因此venture into比单纯的go into / enter多了一层。该词汇有以下近义表达：

get into：开始从事、涉足某个行业、活动或领域。比较口语化。He got into the technology business after graduating from college. 他大学毕业后进入了科技行业。区别：get into 很常见，但比较口语；venture into 更正式，更适合新闻、商业和学术语境。

branch into：在原有业务基础上拓展到新的领域。The company has branched into online education. 这家公司已经拓展到在线教育领域。区别：branch into 往往意味着“原来已经有一项业务，现在向外拓展”。例如：A car company branches into financial services.= 一家汽车公司在原有汽车业务之外，拓展金融服务业务。而venture into 不一定要求原来有相关业务。“大胆涉足一个新的、未知的、有一定风险的领域”。

delve into：深入研究或者深入探讨某个领域或问题。Researchers are delving into the causes of genetic diseases. 研究人员正在深入研究遗传疾病的成因。区别：这个词和venture into 很容易区分：venture into → 涉足一个领域

delve into → 深入研究一个问题

(Para.1) Couples desperate for a clever child might be better advised to focus on what happens after birth.

desperate for 表示“极度渴望的；急切的”，for 后面接你渴望或急需的名词/名词短语。1. 基本结构：be desperate for + 名词。例如：They are desperate for a child. 他们非常渴望拥有一个孩子。该词汇有以下近义表达：

eager for：热切希望得到某物，强调强烈的期待，但通常没有desperate for 那么强烈、急迫。Many young people are eager for success. 许多年轻人都渴望成功。区别：eager for → 热切期待、渴望。desperate for → 极度渴望、迫切需要

long for：强烈渴望某人或某物，常带有一种持续而深切的情感，有时含有“渴盼”的意味。She longed for a chance to prove herself. 她渴望得到一个证明自己的机会。区别：long for 更强调内心深处、持续的渴望；desperate for 更强调迫切程度。

上不存在完美的婴儿，政府就不应阻碍他们获取更多
一点关于胚胎的信息。